

### BHEL to produce and sell ISRO's lithium-ion cells in India

Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has transferred its indigenous technology to produce space-grade lithium-ion cells to Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL). BHEL is in the process of setting up its lithium-ion production facility near Bengaluru. This production facility is primarily targeted at meeting li-ion cell requirements for ISRO and other strategic sectors, which would also include automotive.

### MG Motor, Exicom team up for EV battery recycling

MG Motor India has partnered with Exicom Tele-Systems for second-life use of ZS EV (electric vehicle) batteries. Under the partnership, Exicom plans to re-deploy MG ZS EV batteries at the end of their useful life in the car. It will also put these batteries through a controlled process of evaluation, disassembly and repackaging to design custom battery packs for non-automotive applications. These battery packs can be used in many non-automotive applications like home inverters, commercial and industrial UPS and renewable energy storage.

### Defunct Nokia plant in Chennai set to reopen

The defunct Nokia plant in Sriperumbudur, Chennai is set to reopen, five years after it shut shop in 2014 following a tax

dispute. Finland-based Salcomp, a key supplier of chargers for Apple, has taken over the plant, along with a unit of Taiwan-based component maker LiteOnMobile for nearly ₹ 3.5 billion. Salcomp will invest twenty billion rupees in the next five years.

### MediaTek, Intel join hands to bring 5G connectivity to PCs

MediaTek has entered into a partnership with Intel to bring MediaTek's new 5G modem to PCs. Intel has said that through this partnership, it has been working with MediaTek on the 5G solution for deployment in consumer and commercial laptop segments. Joe Chen, president, Mediatek, says, "With this partnership, consumers will be able to browse, stream and game faster on their PCs, but we also expect them to innovate with 5G in ways we have not yet imagined."

### LED Expo and Light India to merge

Messe Frankfurt India, the organiser of LED Expo and Light India (which are organised in association with ELCOMA, the apex body of the lighting industry), has decided to merge the Delhi editions of the two biggest lighting trade shows. The strategic move will create the biggest platform for the Indian lighting business, titled Light + LED Expo India 2020.

"Hopefully, in a short period of time, a new policy will be put in place to encourage domestic manufacturers."

He also stated that energy-efficiency is one of the priority areas for the government.

### Government gives approval for setting up of defence cyber agency

Union minister of state for defence, Shripad Naik, said that the government has approved the setting up of a defence cyber agency to control and coordinate joint cyber operations. According to PTI, in a written response to a question in the Lok Sabha, Naik said that to mitigate cyber threats, all three services of the armed forces have established their respective Cyber Emergency Response Teams (CERT).

The report also said that adequate safeguards have been implemented in the form of cyber audits, physical checks and policy guidelines for a strong cyber defence structure within the armed forces. The government is also allocating a part of the defence budget for cyber operations and capability development.

In response to a question on whether India has developed deterrence capabilities against adversaries who could attack Indian satellites,

Naik said that such information is strategic and sensitive in nature and cannot be disclosed in the interests of national security.

### Foxconn reopens Indian manufacturing unit as Asian smartphone demand grows

Foxconn has again started manufacturing activity at its Chennai factory inside Nokia Telecom SEZ. The unit was closed as part of a collective shuttering of phone and component factories after Nokia's exit from the cellphone manufacturing business in late 2014, according to an English daily.

Trial production has begun at the factory, said a top government official in Tamil Nadu, adding that production was "part of 2019 Global Investors Meet (GIM) MoU they [Foxconn] signed with us promising ₹ 25 billion of investment in Tamil Nadu."

FIH Developers, part of Foxconn Group, signed the MoU earlier last year to expand manufacturing of components that is projected to create 20,000 jobs, according to a state government press release.

### Panasonic exits chip business

Japanese electronics giant Panasonic has said it is exiting the semiconduc-

tor business, selling its loss-making subsidiary to a Taiwanese firm as it struggles with intense competition from China and South Korea. It marks the end of an era for the once iconic Japanese business, with Panasonic seen as a global chipmaking powerhouse in the 1980s and 1990s.

The Japanese conglomerate is offloading its subsidiary Panasonic Semiconductors Solutions to Taiwan's Nuvoton, with the sale scheduled to take place in June. A spokesperson for the firm told AFP that Panasonic would receive US\$ 250 million. The firm also said it was the best way in the face of extremely intense competition with rival firms' business expansion and massive investment.

The unit logged an operating loss of 23.5 billion Yen (US\$ 215 million) for the fiscal year ended in March, according to Nikkei business daily. Panasonic, as a whole, forecast a 27 per cent drop in operating profit to 300 billion yen last fiscal year to March 2020.

Recently, Panasonic had said it would end production of liquid crystal display (LCD) panels by 2021, again in the face of Chinese and South Korean manufacturers dominating the global market.